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Labour

Haki na Usawa

# 2024 - 2029

# The Strategic Plan

The Editorial Secretariat Labour Party of Kenya 2024-2029

Labour Party of Kenya

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# 1. Introduction

Since its founding in 1998, Labour Party of Kenya (LPK) central themes has been to strengthen its position as a key political party in order to contribute to the consolidation of representative democracy. LPK has carried out indispensable functions such as channeling the demands of citizens, developing policies and programs, selecting candidates for the Executive and Legislative powers, as well as monitoring the sitting government. These are functions that in present-day democracies forward looking political parties must continuously engage in.

We would like to express our deepest gratitude to Netherlands Institute for Multiparty Democracy for developing a Strategic Planning Tool for Political Parties that became a focal point for utilization and generation of the strategic plan developed.

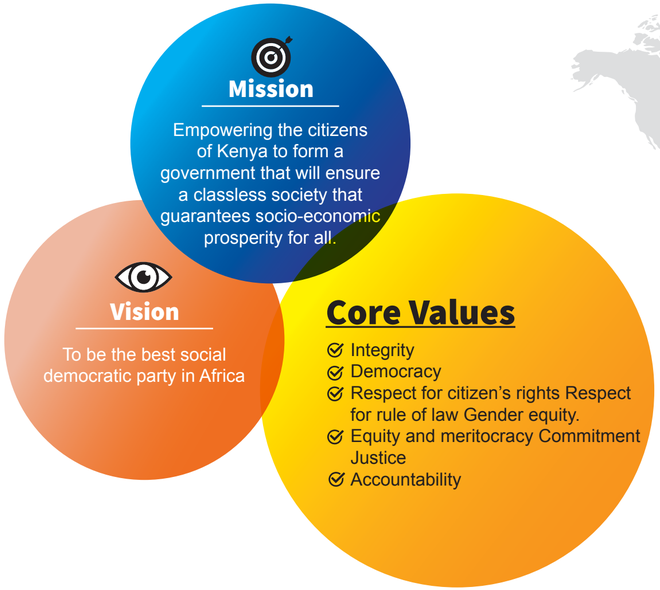
We would also like to thank the Centre for Multiparty Democracy in Kenya for providing the institutional and implementing framework for the Strategic Planning Program for the ten political parties involved.

We recognize the office of the Registrar of Political Parties in offering a supportive role in the implementation of the Strategic Planning Tool hence playing a big role not only as a regulator but an enhancer of institutional capacity development of political parties.

We are also eternally grateful to the socialist family (Socialist International (SI) and International Union of Socialist Youth (IUSY)) for the great role they have played in inspiring Labour Party of Kenya to pursue a Progressive Social Democratic Agenda in attainment of its political goals more so through experiences gained in conferences and workshops in which LPK has participated in.

Finally, we wish to celebrate the LPK leadership under our party leader Hon. Prof. Julia Ojiambo and the entire LPK staff in accomplishing the overall strategies envisioned the Strategic Plan. It is through their hard work, dedication, collaboration, and expertise and of course with the support of the party members that they will bring these initiatives to fruition.

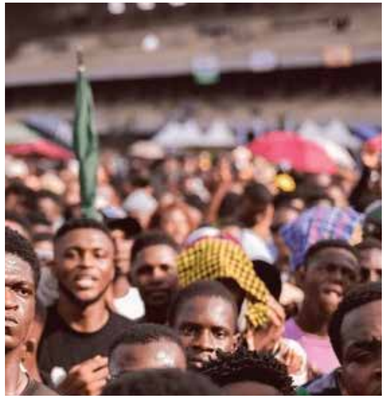
# 2. Vision, Mission and Core Values






# 3. Our Guiding Principles

a. The Youth and women
b. Improved quality of life for all
c. Total elimination of inequality and poverty
d. Globalization



# 4. Our Commitment to the Workers

Labour parties all over the world are anchored on the philosophy of social reforms that give all workers that equal share of the well-being that was in olden days only enjoyed by fortunate classes. It is our collective belief as social democrats that the state is the agency whose full power should be exerted for the betterment of the material interests of the people. The state must enact indiscriminate labour laws, determine minimum conditions of health, security and comfort of the workers, ensure favorable compensation against the four great contingencies threatening the economic security of the individual-accident, sickness, old age and inability to find work, means its failure to meet that duty which it is the prime function of a constitutional government under the bill of right of life, liberty and the pursuit of happiness.

# 5.Background Information

## a. Who are we?

The Labour party of Kenya was first registered under the Societies Act on 30th March 1998 and later under the PPA2007. The party fully complied with the new Political Parties Act. 2011 (PPA2011) and has been registered as a Political party, Registration Certificate No. 3 on the 29th March 2012.

The party is over Sixteen years old since inception and was founded on social democracy as its political ideology, with a major focus on the welfare of workers, gender parity and equal opportunities for all the Kenyan people – to include the disabled people and minority groups, existing harmoniously in a peaceful and just society.

The Labour Party of Kenya has a membership of approximately 46,000 members spread in thirty counties across Kenya.
Hon. Prof. Julia Ojiambo and Mr. Martin Gavole are the current National Chairperson and Secretary General of the party.

## b. Our Journey

Since its formation, the Labour Party of Kenya has been an active player in Kenyan politics. The Party's political platform for the past ten years has been that of a Progressive Reform agenda. Our motivation as LPK was to see a new constitutional dispensation that propagated democracy in all forms.
Labour party participated greatly in the formulation of the Bomas Draft and consequently in the 2005 referendum to defeat the Wako Draft that was being sneaked in, in pretext of the Bomas draft. August 2010 saw a new dawn in Kenya when the New CONSTITUTION was promulgated. It is worth noting that great gains in terms of social justice, human rights, devolution, gender parity and representation were achieved.
In the legislative front, Labour party has contributed to enactment of laws governing the Cotton Industry, Nutrition, Public Procurement procedures and Gender parity and affirmative action.

## c. The Party Structure

**The LPK party structure comprises of the following:**

| | |
|---|---|
| 1. The National Delegates Congress | 6. The Party Branches and Sub Branches |
| 2. The Supreme Council | 7. The National Elections Board |
| 3. The National Executive Council | 8. The National Appeals Board |
| 4. The Party Secretariat | 9. The Disciplinary Committee. |
| 5. The Party Congresses (women, youth, Disability and Marginalized groups) | |



## d. Our Local and International Engagement

1. Elected Representation:
2. PPF Coalition Forum
3. Centre for Multi Party Democracy
4. Socialist International (SI)
5. Socialist International Women Congress
6. International Union of Socialist Youth (IUSY)
7. Women Academy for Africa (WAFA)
8. Civil Society Movement

## e. The Constitution of Kenya

With promulgation of the new constitution in August 2010, came the ominous task to begin unpacking the constitution in order to ensure the Kenyan citizenry realizes the promises enshrined in the new constitution. A number of articles of the constitution recognize the sovereign power of the people and envisages representative and participatory political engagement is on offer.
Having a robust multiparty democracy is not an option but a must hence the need for political parties to realign their political agenda in line with the constitution. This can only be attained through a clearly defined roadmap in a strategic plan. Labour Party of Kenya seeks to strategically position itself as a progressive social democratic party that resonates with the wishes and aspirations of Kenyans in accordance.

## f. The Political Parties Act 2011 (PPA 2011)

The Political Parties Act 2011 (PPA 2011) provides for the registration of political parties as well as funding and regulatory framework, within which political parties are required to operate within.
The PPA 2011 places an enormous task on political parties to have at least 24 county offices with staff operating in them. This legal requirement places a financial obligation on the parties without factoring in the much-needed sources of income. Other legal requirements of the PPA2011 such as submission of audited accounts, publication of declarations in the public dailies among others does place financial cost element on political parties as well.
LPK realizes and appreciates that resource mobilization is the key driver to the vibrancy of a political party to remain relevant and engaged politically in the country.

## g. Kenya's Political Landscape

Since the last General elections in March of 2022, Kenya has been engulfed in a myriad of issues without any clear-cut solutions in sight to address the challenges.
The year 2022 saw erosion in our national moral fabric especially in the recorded massive corruption in the public sector, mutilation of the constitution as well as the rule of law by the ruling elite, the enactment of a new media law that eroded previous gains made in the attainment of free media in Kenya among others. The newly elected government has also been oblivious of the public opinion, starting on a bad footing by escalating the corruption to new levels where people close to power can be seen to show opulence, extravagance and arrogance never witnessed before in the history of our Country. All the different arms of governance have been subdued by the executive and the two houses charged with voicing the interest of the people that is the National Assembly and the Senate are now just goons for hire to rubber-stamp the wishes of the executive.
The failure of the government to listen to the public opinion led them to impose heavy taxation on the people amid very high cost of living, that was epitomized by the parliament passing unpopular finance bill 2023\2024 leading to a historical revolt by the

young people who call themselves the GenZ generation. The ever-mushrooming Government wage bill continues to take center stage as a national debate on the same rages on, every season the government officials continue to increase their salaries, without growing the economic to improve the quality of lives of the people they governed.

## Stakeholder Analysis

Through the strategic planning tool, a stakeholder identification process and analysis were carried out by the Project team and the NEC. The diagram below shows the identification of the party stake holders both internal and external.

| External Stakeholders | Internal Stakeholders |
|---|---|
| 01 Workers Unions, The Public | 01 The Party Leadership |
| 02 NGOs' (CMD/NDI etc.) | 02 The NEC |
| 03 Government, Registrar Political Parties, IEBC | 03 The Secretariat |
| 04 Socialist International | 04 The Party membership in the counties |
| 05 Media, Colleges/Universities | 05 Elected Party representatives |
| 06 Other Political Parties | |

The party viewed the internal stakeholder as any person, group or organization inside the political party that can make claim on the party's attention, resources or outputs, or that is affected by the party's outputs.

Similarly, the party also in turn views an external stakeholder as any person, group or organization inside the political party that can make claim on the party's attention, resources or outputs, or that is affected by the party's outputs.



## Priority areas for the Labour Party's future

1. To revamp the party structure and ensure functionality of all party organs in accordance with the party constitution and also in line with the new devolved structure
2. Focus on continuous party profiling
3. Capacity building of party membership in the counties
4. Ensure women, youth, disability and marginalized groups are mainstreamed into the party'spolitical agenda
5. Continuously engage on Labour issues and be in the fore front of the Labour movement.
6. Activate new party branches in the counties to ensure public participation through LPK
7. Focus on establishing training and study centers for disseminating information and training
8. Build capacity of secretariat staff on a regular basis.
9. Develop partnerships with media, NGOs, and other interested stakeholders

# 6. Emerging Key Strategic Issues and Objectives

This chapter outlines the key emerging issues in the application of the strategic planning tool and from which strategic objectives are derived and developed into key strategies and activities for implementation. Take note of the party's focus areas outlined in chapter 2. The focus areas have now been collapsed into thematic areas for better understanding and implementation.

## a) The new Devolved Structure at County Level

With promulgation of the new constitution, the country's governance structures became devolved to counties hence more resource allocation to the counties setting the stage for increased governance structures and enhanced public engagement and participation at county level. It is only prudent that the party reviews its existing party structure in order to ensure effective party participation at both national and county level through its existing party structure.

## b) Public Consciousness and Awareness

Today the Kenyan populace is more conscious on political matters than before. The promulgation of the new constitution set the stage for more and enhanced public participation in leadership and governance structures. Kenyans are seeking active avenues through which to participate and engage on leadership and governance issues both at county and national level.

Political parties provide the right forums and platforms for people to collectively air their opinions on the way they are being governed or offer alternative political solutions to emerging political challenges.

## c) Emerging Political Challenges

Almost all political parties in Kenya are similar in the manner in which the Kenyan public views them. No single party can claim ownership of a specific national agenda or even claim to spear head a particular cause for the Kenyan people.

Since the last General Election on 4th March 2013, a lot of issues have emerged on Kenya's political landscape offering great challenges to the very existence of the nation itself.

**05** The ongoing struggles with our sovereignty in the international space

**06** The existing confrontation between the Judiciary and the Legislature

**07** Rising insecurity in the country

**08** High unemployment rate among the youth, and the threat of terrorism etc.

**01** The passing of the draconian and punitive media bill into law.

**02** The onslaught by government on the civil society movement

**03** The rogue parliament that is misusing its tyranny of numbers

**04** The war between the senate and the national assembly

**These are some of the challenges witnessed in the past one year**



## d. Low Level Management and Inclusivity of Youth, Women, Persons with Disability and Marginalized Communities in Governance

Engagement, participation and inclusivity of Youth, Women, Disabled persons and marginalized communities in political activities is still a major concern both at national and county level. These groupings have continually found it difficult to be involved in mainstream politics despite the concerted legal framework provided constitutionally. The representation of women in elective assemblies in Kenya is still below the 30% threshold set by the United Nations in trying to equalize gender distribution in elective representation globally.

It's the duty of political parties to create structural interfaces within their organizational outlook and operational outlay that will deliberately include and enhance the participation of the youth, women, disabled persons and the marginalized communities.

## e) Resource Mobilization

Political Mobilization is "the process of forming crowds, groups, associations, and organizations for the pursuit of collective political agenda". Political Organizations do not "spontaneously emerge" but require the mobilization of resources.

The existing new law on funding of political parties has resulted in about 95% of the parties missing out on funding hence posing a great challenge to the advancement of democracy. There are various resource needs in starting political organizations (technology, labor, capital, organizational structure, societal support, legitimacy, etc.).

LPK must now clearly address the issues of resource mobilization in order to have a well thought and structured approach to its political agenda both internally and externally. Resource mobilization will be look at in three key areas that is:

1. Financial base and capacity
2. Human resource
3. Asset base and party structure

## f) Low Level Representation in Governance Structures

Elective representation is a key factor in determining a party's strength both at national and county level and equally sets the stage for political engagement, participation and the possibility to influence policy formation as well as implementation. The importance of having more elected representatives in legislative assemblies is therefore a critical goal that any serious political party wanting to impact the socio-economic fabric of its citizenry, must consider and take as a primary objective to creating change.

To date LPK doesn't have any county representation in the 47 county assemblies and no elected member of the National Assembly or Senate. This is a great deterrent to the party in pushing for legislative changes in the respective assemblies at national and county level.

Policy formulation will form a critical focus point for the party in being able to influence legislative change that has an impact on the lives of Kenyans in being able to generate positive change

## g) International and Local Solidarity Engagement

No political struggle has ever been worn singularly. Solidarity of purpose is key in pursuing political goals from an ideological standpoint that is shared by likeminded individuals as well as political parties. Best practices and experiences of successful political agendas always set the stage for learning platforms to be shared and emulated.

LPK's political agenda mustn't be an internal party agenda identified and owned by only its members but also a political struggle that resonates with those individuals and parties belonging to the same political school of thought/ideology. The party has to seek out partnerships both locally and internationally as this will form an integral part of the resource mobilization strategy as well as exchange of best practices and experiences in political leadership.

## h) Existing Leadership Gaps and Membership Lacking in Political Leadership

To revitalize the country's leadership as well as party leadership and ensure continuity in leadership both at party level and at national level, LPK MUST tackle fundamental questions such as: -

1. What is leadership and why is it important?
2. What kind of leadership contributes to effective, legitimate governance in nations and communities?
3. How can you evaluate your leadership for governance?
4. How can you develop the next generation of strong leaders?

Training of leaders in a political setup is a very important aspect of developing sound leaders for a nation. As political parties seek to be in charge of government, they have an ultimate responsibility to provide good and credible leadership that is visionary and well- articulated for purposes of good governance. These aspects of leadership cannot be left to chance hence the need to develop training needs, resources and expected training outcomes through a structured framework.

Training of leaders as well as empowering Kenyan citizenry on leadership and Governance is therefore is an emerging key issue that the party seeks to critically look into in its strategic planning in the next 5 years.

## i) Workers Voice on Editorials

The Kenyan worker today is at the very core of the country's economy yet a majority of them lack a voice or a medium through which they can voice their opinions and share their challenges/struggles. The workers unions out there have failed in agitating for better working conditions and remuneration of the Kenyan workers.

Labour Party Kenya despite its name has equally failed to fill in the gap occasioned by poor representation of the Kenyan workers. There is a growing need to voice the struggles of the Kenyan workers and to share in their plight as well as agitate for better working conditions. LPK is seeking to provide that medium through print media as one of its key strategic issues.



## j) Party Foundation

As much as a lot of the conflicts experienced today around the country and globally are politically instigated, it is very difficult to build bridges and make peace with the warring factions while in political attires/gloves. To have any chance of arriving at any tangible peaceful resolution engaging a neutral perspective might be the starting point.

Political parties are not only formed to wrestle for power but to be vehicles for positive change through various initiatives (mostly socio-economic and peaceful activities). But to be effective in some of these initiatives it then becomes necessary to use alternative means such as the party's foundation.

LPK has an existing foundation already in place hence the most important thing will be to activate the foundation and strategically engage it in the party's political agenda in activities that may seemingly need a neutral perspective in terms of active participation. Such activities may include charity activities as well as peace initiatives and events.

# 7. The Strategic Objectives and Strategies

From the emerging issues identified above, strategic objectives to be achieved in the planning period and strategies to be implemented to achieve the objectives have been developed.

### Strategic Direction #1
### To Strengthen Party Organs/Structures

**FOCUS:**

To develop clear party internal strategies on how best to operationalize the various party organs ensuring that each organ delivers on its mandate and functions while at the same time working in tandem with the other party organs.

The party structures that are to be strengthened are the

## Strategic Direction # 2
Increased Party Membership in the Counties

**FOCUS:**
To continuously recruit new party members into the party primarily focusing on the party's ideology. There is need to increase the membership of the party at county level with an emphasis to increase participation and engagement of the party at county level. LPK currently has a membership base of approximately 46,500 members in 27 counties. There is need to scale up membership of the party in at least 47 counties across the country in order to ensure national outlook and ownership of the party agenda by the Kenyan people.

## Strategic Direction #3
To Profile the Party and Position it as a Party of choice for most Kenyans

**FOCUS:**
To strategically front and position Labour Party as a party of choice for most Kenyans by ensuring the party focuses on mundane issues that affect and resonate with the aspirations of the wananchi.
This strategic objective includes identifying critical areas within the party that affect the party image and have direct bearing on general public perceptions on how the party looks and the potential it possesses.

## Strategic Direction #4
Strengthening Engagement, Representation, Inclusivity of Youth, Women, Disability and Marginalized Communities

**FOCUS:**
To continuously and deliberately focus on mainstreaming women, youth and disability groups in party political activities and national politics. The youth and women form a large part of Kenya's population and yet their level of political engagement still remains quite low when viewed from political parties and elective assemblies.



## Strategic Direction #5
To Develop Sustainable Resource Mobilization Strategies

**FOCUS:**
To develop sound and clearly thought-out resource mobilization strategies that will center on sustainable fundraising strategies and proper human resource development and utilization within the party.
The party aims to constitute a resource mobilization committee whose mandate will be primarily to fundraise for the party based on the needs identified. The treasurer of the party shall be assigned the co-ordination role whereas the NEC shall be in charge of the entire process.
This is the core of the party's affairs and focuses in material and human resources needed to run all the affairs of the party i.e. secretariat, public engagement, communication and leadership strengthening. It is also critical to have enough resources to implement socio-economic development programs for the youth, women, elderly, people with disability and other vulnerable groups as well as facilitate political campaigns.

## Strategic Direction #6
Increased Representation in Governance Structures

**FOCUS:**
To have a parliamentary group and county assembly group for each of the party branches after the next General election. This Parliamentary and County groups form part of the leadership at county level and will be key strategic drivers of influencing policies and change.
It is very important that LPK dominate the political arena by having enough leaders in both the county and parliamentary assemblies; this will help us create checks and balances to the activities of other active political parties, influence national policy and decision making as well as create monitoring and control mechanism for the excesses of the ruling party. The political leaders will also help to keep the ideology, vision and the mission of the party alive Ensure constant engagement of the party with the general public, attract local, regional and international material and human support to the party and maintain the party-political relevance.

## Strategic Direction #7
Develop and Strengthen International and Local Solidarity

**FOCUS:**
To work with likeminded political parties, organizations and individuals who share the same ideological platform in addressing common global challenges and having agreeable international political standpoints that outlines solutions that are grounded on the socialist ideology.
This will involve establishing bilateral relations with other likeminded political parties/organizations and individuals that profess socialist ideology while at the same time seeking to share best practices and experiences through exchange programs.

**Strategic Direction #8**
To Establish a Leadership Institute for Democracy and Governance

**FOCUS:**
To develop training needs and a curriculum aimed at instituting in-house training of party members of LPK. The focus of this training will be to ensure that all membership within the party shall have a proper understanding of the party ideology and be able to articulate the party policies in accordance with the party ideology.
The leadership institute will also focus on training party members on leadership and governance principles based on party ideology, principles and values.
The leadership institute will have a set of trainers who initially begin by conducting the trainings using study centers at various locations in the country.

**Strategic Direction #9**
To Develop Editorials that agitates and Advocates for the Rights of Kenyan Workers

**FOCUS:**
To develop through print media a medium through which to agitate for the plight of the Kenyan workers as a critical party niche in Kenya's political landscape.
The Kenyan Labour Movement has been poorly represented over the years by the various players who should have stood up for the rights of Kenyan workers. LPK is equally at fault for seizing the opportunity to do so. LPK wants to stand out as the "Workers Party" and strongly believes that print media is the starting point of the agitation battle towards ensuring the voice of the Kenyan worker remains heard at all times.

**Strategic Direction #10**
**To promote and realize Labour standards and fundamental principles and rights of Kenyan workers and safe work environments.**

**FOCUS:**
1. Lobby for workers' rights that guarantee decent pay hence ensuring dignity of life
2. Lobby for workers' rights that promote safe working environments
3. Lobby, agitate and influence progressive legislation on Labour in Kenya.
4. Assist Kenyan workers to solve labour related disputes by connecting them to legal services
5. Undertake Labour related surveys within the sector to effectively advise and inform the Kenyan workers and the populace at large on the state of Kenya's Labour market.
6. Become a credible source of information on matters Labour in Kenya and across the continent.
7. Offer progressive policy frameworks on Labour exportation and importation from and into Kenya with a singular aim of protecting the fundamental working rights of Kenyan workers
8. Conduct awareness campaigns on the plight of Kenyan workers both within Kenya and in the diaspora.
9. To develop close relations with workers unions both nationally and globally for purposes of synergizing on workers' rights.
10. Actively campaign against all forms of Child Labour
11. Building international solidarity on Labour issues globally
12. Host workshops/conferences/ seminars/ festivals etc. on rights and dignity of life for workers.



# 8. Resource Mobilization & Risk Management

## a) Resource Mobilization

The Labour party of Kenya previously had funding from the political parties' fund and this was in accordance with the PPA 2007 which allowed all political parties to be funded. The new act PPA 2011 however introduced a 5% threshold for funding and effectively locked out 95% of the political parties. Labour party of Kenya was locked out of the funding bracket as well.
In addition to the government funding LPK had other sources of funding which included Membership contributions, Sale of membership cards, and donations in kind which only added up to 12% of total income received within the last financial year.
LPK's secretariat budget per financial year without involving programs and activities at county level is approximately KES 15-million. With the Strategic Plan now in place the stage is set for more spending by the party.

## b) Risk Management

In implementing this plan, there are a number of risk factors to the implementation process. The matrix below summarizes possible risks to this plan including a ranking and suggested mitigation strategies.

| No. | Risk Factor | Rank | Risk Management |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Ownership of the Plan | High | Consultation, inclusion and consensus |
| 2 | The PPA 2011 | High | Push for amendments in the Act |
| 3 | Volatile Political landscape | High | Be aware and re-strategize |
| 4 | Existing capacity of secretariat | High | Establish funding mechanism |
| 5 | Financial resource | High | Source for funding from donors and likeminded individuals and organisations |
| 6 | Dynamic Technological inventions | Medium | Invest in ICT and training |
| 7 | Stakeholders interest | Medium | Involve them from the start |
| 8 | External interference | Medium | The party leadership must be assertive |
| 9 | Membership Resistance to change | Medium | Proper structures with effective communication strategy |
| 10 | Negative Perception of the Kenyan public towards political parties | Medium | Positive publicity and engaging the public on a continuous basis |
| 11 | Non commitment and adherence to the monitoring and evaluation process | Low | Establish loyal party members who are sold out to the course |